

Change in name

Samsung Galaxy Tab 10.1 has now been renamed to Tab 10.1V

Nook Update

Due for an update in April, Nook Color would get Flash and apps integration

AMD Radeon HD 6990 arrives - the world's fastest, and noisiest graphics card

AMD has finally launched the successor to the Radeon HD 5970, transferring the crown of the world's fastest graphics card to the new single-slot dual-GPU champion - HD 6990 (Antilles). While the world now awaits a dual-GPU offering from Nvidia ie. the GTX 590, let us give the newly launched card its due before a pair of overclocked GTX 580s snatch its laurels from it.

The Antilles HD 6990 is built out of two Cayman HD 6970 GPUs, with precisely twice the stream processors - 3072, texture units - 192, ROPs - 64, and video memory - 4GB GDDR5. Just like the Hemlock HD 5970 however, which was built out of two Cypress HD 5870 GPUs, the dual GPU core and memory clock speeds have been lowered from their single GPU counter parts. The drop this time however has not

been as significant, with a 5.5 per cent drop in core clock speeds to 830 MHz from 880 MHz, and a 9 per cent drop in memory clock speeds to 5.0 GHz from 5.5 GHz. All this equals an average 22 per cent boost in performance over the HD 5970. The card is also a bit less massive as the HD 5970, measuring in at 11.5-inches.

Underclocking the HD 6990's dual-GPU setup was a decision that must have not been taken lightly, but when paired with a launch price of

\$699, the HD 6990 becomes more than twice as expensive as two HD 6970 cards in CrossFire, a combination that is faster on many fronts - fast enough to nearly outweigh the disadvantages of a CrossFire setup. In fact, the even cheaper HD 6950 CF setup is very comparable in performance to the HD 6990.

Another variable in the above equation is of course



power consumption, and the HD 6990 has taken that crown from the HD 5970 as well, ranking up a mind-boggling official load TDP of 375W. Power consumption under serious load goes even higher, up to nearly 500W, and nearly 550W when overclocked. The official idle TDP of the HD 6990 however, is lower than the HD 5970, at 37W.

The card's overclocking headroom is also significant, but would require a seriously heavy duty power supply unit and after market cooling solutions to be able to approach the AMD Overdrive limits. A dual-BIOS switch is also provided, just like the HD 6970 and HD 6950. BIOS2 is pre-configured with AMD overclocked settings, with a 50 MHz boost in core clock speeds, and nothing else.

For now, the AMD Radeon HD 6990 occupies a spot on the mantelpiece of the industry rather than in the fireplace of competition, and is more an exposition in engineering than a sensible purchase - unless of course you don't care about price, noise or power consumption, and got to have the world's fastest graphics card in your cabinet, perhaps in a Quad-CrossFire setup? ■



LED E60 ELEGANT AND MINIMALIST

LG announced the launch of its brand new LED E60 monitor series the very latest in monitor high-tech. With a depth of just 12.9mm, the E60 is the **slimmest** of any LG monitor. E60 adds a host of superb features such as LED backlighting, mega contrast ratio, easy-to-use **EZ Control OSD**, photo effects and a 5 ms response time. The E60 monitor series offers a suite of eco-conscious features including **reduced energy** consumption.

Sony: PlayStation 3 pirates will be banned for life

A lot has gone on back and forth between Sony and the hackers recent jailbreak exploits that have made vulnerable the Sony PS3. Legal battles are ensuing, but in the meantime, Sony has issued an ultimatum that should keep most people in check for a while "if a user hacks the PlayStation 3, that user will be banned for life from Sony's online services, permanently." Online services include the Play-

Station Network, and Qriocity audio streaming service.

A few days after the above edict was issued, came the news of a method that effectively neutralized the ban threat. The hack claims to be able to unban banned consoles, individually, by sneaking into PSN and making validity changes. The hack methodology can in theory also allow hackers to ban consoles that have not been banned, but before you

clutch your PS3-owning heart, rest assured that your console's ID would have to be known by the hackers before they can ban your console from PSN.

As expected, the hackers are adamant that their seemingly vindictive riposte is in fact most righteous, and is in fact only removing the injustices perpetuated by Sony's recent attempts to bully the PS3 mod-scene into submission.

So, it is advantage hackers right now, with possible losers including the general public, apart from Sony of course. We can't wait for deuce, and Sony's response. ■